



Apple's AR headset by 2020

According to Bloomberg report, Apple might come up with an AR headset to succeed the iPhone by 2020. <http://digit.in/AppleARHS>



Workaround to deleted messages

Reports claims that users can view deleted messages in WhatsApp with a third party app called 'Notification History.' <http://digit.in/DelMsg>

Another startup that is doing some interesting work in this area is Crofarm. Rather than going for the discovery based approach of Farm-ily, Crofarm is based on replacing the archaic middleman of the system with a more proactive, helpful one. Crofarm allows farmers to list themselves with them, along with the crops they can provide and the cities they can service (based on proximity). On the other hand, based on market demand, Crofarm advises farmers regarding the harvest to ensure that their crop is optimally used. And with a digitised supply chain to connect it all, they also aim for a zero-wastage supply chain, that greatly reduces operational costs for them as well and allows them to properly execute doorstep delivery.

With these startups and all the different approaches they've taken to bridging the gap between the farmer and the consumer, the days of the middleman could very well be over. Now it remains to be seen how well their offerings are taken up, considering how we are used to ordering everything from one place – a la Big Basket, Grofers etc. (which also happen to be customers for Crofarm, along with Big Bazaar)

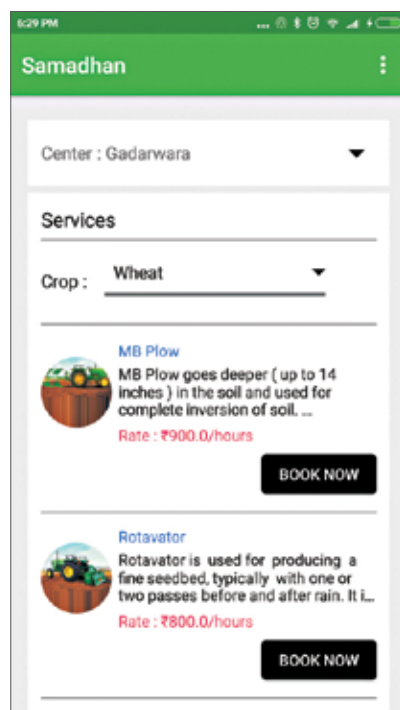
FARMING-AS-A-SERVICE

While the middleman might be one of the biggest problems in the agriculture sector, it is by no means the only significant one. Existing aspects of the industry face a lot of roadblocks on a regular basis and that is another area where startups focus their attention. Yes, we are, at some level, talking about farming-as-a-service.

To solve the problem of availability of equipment, startups like EM3 Agri are providing farming equipment and services on a pay-per-use basis, under the Samadhan service banner. This includes services spanning across sowing, crop management, harvesting, post harvest farm management as well as land preparation. They currently operate in Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh and have also forayed into Delhi.

CropIn wants to digitize the entire farm operation through its family of

apps. For instance, SmartFarm is a farm management app that lets you manage your farm field force, monitor pest status and more. And if you view this from an ERP perspective, then SmartFarm is the monitoring ERP and similarly CropInSights is the analytical aspect of it. SmartChat



EM3 Agri's Samadhan lets farmers rent equipment on a pay-per-use model

brings enterprise-style messaging to a farming organisation. These and other apps offered by CropIn bring the power of software-based organisation tools to farming enterprises.

Another important aspect of farming in India is storage of the crop produced. Typically, large scale cold storage facilities are utilised by many farmers. But even in this area, startups like Tessol are providing a touch of innovation by implementing Eutectic cooling solutions and providing services like cold chain logistics and last mile deliveries.

The advantages offered by such services are many. First of all, farmers don't have to maintain expensive equipment and tools around the year and can avail them as and when needed. And since it's on a pay per use basis, farmers can avail far better

equipment and services at the same or even lower expenditure than before.

FARMING 2.0

Beyond removing roadblocks or improving existing services, Indian companies are also bringing in innovation that is entirely new and fresh to



CropIn aims to be the one platform to digitise the entire agriculture ecosystem

solve problems that cannot be tackled by traditional methods. Mahindra, while not a startup, is planning to bring something revolutionary to the farming sector - autonomous tractors. They've already demonstrated the product and are planning to launch it by 2019, whereas a driver assisted version will be launching as early as 2018. Thanks to the culture of innovation around agriculture rapidly growing and evolving, we might be looking at the inception of an entirely transformed ecosystem where the farmer forms a significant and powerful component, as compared to the current role of a mere supply provider. With the correct legislation facilitating the same and increased customer awareness, we might finally be able to do justice to the hands that have been feeding us all this while. 